

learn_lessons					
id	category	title	type	duration	summary
1	Food Safety	Four Steps to Food Safety: Clean	article	3	Cleaning is the first step to prevent foodborne illness. Handwashing and cleaning surfaces remove germs.
2	Food Safety	Four Steps to Food Safety: Separate	article	3	Keeping raw foods separate prevents cross-contamination of germs to ready-to-eat foods.
3	Food Safety	Four Steps to Food Safety: Cook	article	3	Cook foods to safe internal temperatures to kill germs; use a thermometer for accuracy.
4	Food Safety	Four Steps to Food Safety: Chill	article	3	Refrigerate or freeze perishable foods promptly to slow bacterial growth.
5	Food Safety	Risky Foods: What to Avoid	article	3	Certain foods carry higher risk for foodborne illness; know which ones to handle with extra care.
6	Food Safety	Handwashing Basics	article	3	Proper handwashing is one of the most effective ways to prevent foodborne illnesses.
7	Food Safety	Cleaning Surfaces and Utensils	article	3	Wash cutting boards, knives and countertops with hot, soapy water between tasks to prevent germ spread.
8	Food Safety	Rinsing Produce	article	3	Rinse fruits and vegetables under running water to remove dirt and microbes.
9	Food Safety	Don't Wash Raw Chicken	article	3	Washing raw chicken can spread bacteria around your kitchen; cook it directly instead.
10	Food Safety	Separate Grocery Storage	article	3	Keep raw meats separate from other foods in the shopping cart and refrigerator.
11	Food Safety	Separate Cutting Boards	article	3	Use different cutting boards for raw meats and ready-to-eat foods to avoid cross-contamination.
12	Food Safety	Using Food Thermometers	article	3	A food thermometer is the only reliable way to ensure foods reach safe internal temperatures.
13	Food Safety	Safe Temperatures Chart	article	3	Know the safe cooking temperatures for different types of foods.
14	Food Safety	Microwave Cooking Safety	article	3	Follow recommended cooking and standing times when microwaving; let food stand to finish cooking.
15	Food Safety	Refrigeration Rules	article	3	Keep your refrigerator at 40°F or below; freeze at 0°F. Don't leave food out too long.
16	Food Safety	Thawing Food Safely	article	3	Thaw frozen food in the refrigerator, cold water, or microwave—never on the counter.
17	Food Safety	Leftover Safety	article	3	Use refrigerated leftovers within 3–4 days and reheat to 165°F.
18	Food Safety	Danger Zone Awareness	article	3	The "Danger Zone" is 40°F–140°F. Keep food out of this range to prevent bacterial growth.
19	Food Safety	Packaging Hot Food	article	3	Divide warm food into shallow containers for quick cooling before refrigeration.
20	Food Safety	Risk Groups: Who's Most Vulnerable?	article	3	Young children, older adults, pregnant women and immunocompromised individuals are at higher risk for foodborne illness.
21	Food Safety	Safer Food Choices	article	3	Choosing lower-risk foods reduces your chance of getting sick.
22	Food Safety	Symptoms of Foodborne Illness	article	3	Know the common symptoms of food poisoning to recognize and respond quickly.
23	Food Safety	Why Use a Thermometer?	article	3	Colour isn't a reliable indicator of doneness; a thermometer ensures safety.
24	Food Safety	Microwave Wattage Matters	article	3	Know your microwave's wattage to adjust cooking times appropriately.
25	Food Safety	Washing vs. Sanitizing	article	3	Washing removes dirt; sanitizing reduces germs. Do both for surfaces that contact food.
26	Food Safety	Keeping Sponges Safe	article	3	Kitchen sponges can harbor bacteria; clean or replace them regularly.
27	Food Safety	Kitchen Towel Hygiene	article	3	Use separate towels for hands and dishes and launder them regularly.
28	Food Safety	Understanding Food Dates	article	3	"Sell-by," "use-by" and "best-by" dates have different meanings. Don't confuse them.
29	Food Safety	Cross-Contamination in the Fridge	article	3	Store raw meats on the lowest shelf to avoid dripping onto other foods.
30	Food Safety	Storing Food in Sealed Containers	article	3	Use airtight containers to keep foods fresh longer and prevent pests.
31	Food Safety	Freezing Food Effectively	article	3	Freezing preserves foods but quality can degrade; label items and use within recommended times.
32	Food Safety	Using Leftovers Creatively	article	3	Repurpose odds and ends into soups, casseroles, stir fries or smoothies to reduce waste.
33	Food Safety	Serving the Right Portions	article	3	Cooking and serving appropriate portions helps avoid waste and ensures safe leftovers.
34	Food Safety	Cooling Leftovers Quickly	article	3	Cool hot foods quickly to prevent bacteria growth; use shallow containers.
35	Food Safety	Food Thermometer Placement	article	3	Place a food thermometer correctly for an accurate reading.
36	Food Safety	What is the Danger Zone?	article	3	The "Danger Zone" refers to temperatures between 40 and 140°F where bacteria multiply rapidly.
37	Food Safety	Defrosting in Cold Water	article	3	When defrosting in cold water, keep food in a leak-proof bag and change water every 30 minutes.
38	Food Safety	Discarding Recalled Food	article	3	If a food is recalled, discard it immediately and clean any surfaces it touched.
39	Food Safety	Avoiding Raw Dough and Batter	article	3	Raw dough made with uncooked flour or eggs can contain harmful germs.
40	Food Safety	Storing Produce Separately	article	3	Some fruits release ethylene gas that speeds ripening; store separately.
41	Food Safety	Humidity Drawers	article	3	Use your fridge's humidity drawers correctly to keep produce fresh.
42	Food Safety	Storing Root Vegetables	article	3	Potatoes, onions and winter squash prefer cool, dark, well-ventilated storage.
43	Food Safety	Fridge Door Storage	article	3	The refrigerator door is warmest; reserve it for condiments, not milk or eggs.
44	Food Safety	Lower Shelf Rule	article	3	Store meat, poultry and fish on the lower shelves of the fridge to prevent drips.
45	Food Safety	Labelling and Dating Food	article	3	Label containers with contents and dates to avoid guesswork and reduce waste.
46	Food Safety	Wash Berries Last	article	3	Wait to wash berries, cherries and grapes until you're ready to eat them to prevent mold.
47	Food Safety	Refrigerator Thermometer	article	3	Use an appliance thermometer to monitor fridge and freezer temperatures.
48	Food Safety	Cooking Ground Meat	article	3	Ground meat and poultry require higher cooking temperatures than whole cuts.
49	Food Safety	Cooking Fish Safely	article	3	Fish should be cooked to 145°F or until flesh is opaque and flakes easily with a fork.
50	Food Safety	Cooking Leftovers	article	3	Reheat leftovers and casseroles to 165°F to kill any surviving bacteria.
51	Food Safety	Washing Reusable Bags	article	3	Reusable grocery bags should be cleaned regularly to prevent cross-contamination.
52	Food Safety	Avoiding Cross-Contamination During Marinating	article	3	Always marinate foods in the refrigerator, not on the counter, and do not reuse marinades.
53	Food Safety	Safe Picnic Practices	article	3	When eating outdoors, keep hot foods hot and cold foods cold, and don't let food sit out.
54	Food Safety	Transporting Groceries Safely	article	3	Take perishable items home quickly and refrigerate or freeze them promptly.
55	Food Safety	Avoiding Food Waste Through Safety	article	3	Following food safety practices not only protects health but also reduces waste.
56	Food Safety	Using Ice Packs for Lunches	article	3	Pack lunches with ice packs or frozen water bottles to keep food cold until lunchtime.
57	Food Safety	Food Safety for School Lunches	article	3	Teach kids to store lunches properly and throw out perishable leftovers.
58	Food Safety	Handwashing After Pet Contact	article	3	Wash hands after touching pets or pet food to prevent spread of germs to food.
59	Food Safety	Sanitizing Cutting Boards	article	3	Disinfect cutting boards regularly to kill bacteria.
60	Food Safety	Keeping Fridge Organized	article	3	Organize your fridge to ensure proper airflow and avoid forgetting items.
61	Donation Rules	Anyone Can Be a Food Donor	article	3	Individuals, businesses and farms can donate wholesome food and reduce waste.
62	Donation Rules	Donor Types: Beyond Households	article	3	Many entities can donate, including schools and community organizations.
63	Donation Rules	Good Samaritan Food Donation Act	article	3	This U.S. law protects donors who give food in good faith from liability.
64	Donation Rules	2023 Update to the Good Samaritan Act	article	3	Recent updates extend protections to direct donors giving food to individuals in need.
65	Donation Rules	Safety Basics for Donations	article	3	Follow food safety guidelines and local health department advice when donating food.
66	Donation Rules	Packaging and Integrity	article	3	Donate food in original, intact packaging to ensure safety and quality.
67	Donation Rules	Food Acceptability	article	3	Donate only unspoiled, wholesome food—never food that is moldy or contaminated.
68	Donation Rules	Prepared Food Donations	article	3	Restaurants and caterers can donate excess prepared food if it's handled properly.
69	Donation Rules	Labeling Donated Food	article	3	Include preparation dates, ingredients and allergen information on donated food.
70	Donation Rules	Temperature Control During Transport	article	3	Keep cold foods cold and hot foods hot when transporting donations.
71	Donation Rules	Avoiding Home-Canned Foods	article	3	Do not donate home-canned or homemade foods due to safety concerns.
72	Donation Rules	Nonperishable Items Preferred	article	3	Food banks often prefer nonperishable items due to longer shelf life.
73	Donation Rules	Donate Fresh Produce	article	3	Wholesome fruits and vegetables can be donated but should be unspoiled and clean.
74	Donation Rules	Donation Size Considerations	article	3	Check with local organizations for minimum donation sizes and accepted items.
75	Donation Rules	Where to Donate	article	3	Food pantries, food banks and rescue programs distribute donated food to those in need.
76	Donation Rules	Food Rescue Apps	article	3	Apps like MealConnect and Food Rescue US link donors to recipient organizations.
77	Donation Rules	Volunteer with Food Rescue	article	3	Volunteers play a critical role in transporting and distributing donated food.
78	Donation Rules	Tax Benefits for Donations	article	3	Businesses may be eligible for enhanced tax deductions when donating food.
79	Donation Rules	Encouraging Businesses to Donate	article	3	Suggest that local restaurants, venues or schools donate leftover food.
80	Donation Rules	Scheduling Pick-Ups	article	3	Set up regular donation pick-ups to streamline the process.
81	Donation Rules	Donated Food Must Be Wholesome	article	3	Only donate food that meets quality standards and is safe to eat.
82	Donation Rules	Cooling Prepared Foods for Donation	article	3	Cool cooked foods quickly to 41°F before transporting them to donation sites.
83	Donation Rules	Maintaining Temperature Logs	article	3	Keep records of temperatures during storage and transport of donated food.
84	Donation Rules	Hot Holding for Donations	article	3	Keep hot foods at 140°F or above until they are delivered or served.
85	Donation Rules	Cold Holding for Donations	article	3	Keep cold foods at 40°F or below during storage and transport.
86	Donation Rules	Personal Hygiene for Donors	article	3	Those handling donated food should practice good personal hygiene to prevent contamination.
87	Donation Rules	Gleaning from Farms	article	3	Gleaning allows volunteers to harvest unmarketable produce from farms for donation.
88	Donation Rules	Legal Protections for Gleaners	article	3	Gleaners who harvest food for donation also receive liability protection.
89	Donation Rules	Check Local Food Safety Regulations	article	3	Rules for food donation vary by state and locality; consult your health department.
90	Donation Rules	Donating Surplus Crops	article	3	Farmers can donate surplus or cosmetically imperfect crops to reduce waste.
91	Donation Rules	Excess Food from Events	article	3	Plan to donate leftover food from events, meetings and conferences.
92	Donation Rules	Avoiding Donor Negligence	article	3	Ensure that donated food has been handled safely and that donors do not act negligently.
93	Donation Rules	Foods Not to Donate	article	3	Avoid donating foods that require strict temperature control unless you can maintain it.
94	Donation Rules	Educate Employees About Food Donation	article	3	Train staff on safe food handling and donation protocols.
95	Donation Rules	Portioning Donations	article	3	Package donated foods in manageable portion sizes for easier distribution.
96	Donation Rules	Donating Dairy Products	article	3	Donate unopened milk, yogurt and cheese before their expiration dates.
97	Donation Rules	Donating Baked Goods	article	3	Baked goods like bread, muffins and pastries can be donated if free from mold.
98	Donation Rules	Donating Canned Goods	article	3	Check cans for dents, rust and bulges before donating.
99	Donation Rules	Donate Infant Formula Responsibly	article	3	Ensure infant formula is unopened and not expired before donating.
100	Donation Rules	Allergen Awareness in Donations	article	3	Separate and label foods containing common allergens to protect recipients.
101	Donation Rules	Coordinating with Food Banks	article	3	Establish relationships with food banks to understand their specific needs.
102	Donation Rules	Quality Over Quantity	article	3	Focus on donating high-quality foods rather than large volumes of marginal items.
103	Donation Rules	Meal Connect App	article	3	Use the MealConnect app to quickly match surplus food with local food banks.
104	Donation Rules	AmpleHarvest.org	article	3	Gardeners can donate excess produce through AmpleHarvest.org's food pantry directory.
105	Donation Rules	Food Rescue Locator	article	3	Find food rescue organizations in your area with the Food Rescue Locator.
106	Donation Rules	Global Donation Policies	article	3	Different countries have varied policies on food donations; consult the Global Food Donation Policy Atlas.
107	Donation Rules	Avoiding Plate Waste Donations	article	3	Do not donate food that has been served on a diner's plate.
108	Donation Rules	Pick-Up Timing	article	3	Arrange prompt pick-ups to maintain food freshness and safety.
109	Donation Rules	Disposal of Unsafe Donations	article	3	Recipient organizations may discard items that don't meet safety standards.
110	Storage & Portic	Fresh Eggs	article	3	3–5 weeks in fridge; do not freeze eggs in shell
111	Storage & Portic	Hard-Cooked Eggs	article	3	1 week in fridge; don't freeze cooked eggs
112	Storage & Portic	Liquid Pasteurized Eggs (Opened)	article	3	3 days in fridge; do not freeze
113	Storage & Portic	Liquid Pasteurized Eggs (Unopened)	article	3	10 days in fridge; up to 1 year in freezer
114	Storage & Portic	TV Dinners & Frozen Casseroles	article	3	Keep frozen until ready; 3–4 months for quality
115	Storage & Portic	Store-Prepared Salads	article	3	3–5 days in fridge; do not freeze
116	Storage & Portic	Pre-Stuffed Pork & Lamb Chops	article	3	1 day in fridge; do not freeze
117	Storage & Portic	Store-Cooked Convenience Meals	article	3	3–4 days in fridge; do not freeze
118	Storage & Portic	Vacuum-Packed Dinners (Unopened)	article	3	2 weeks in fridge; do not freeze
119	Storage & Portic	Hamburger & Stew Meats	article	3	1–2 days in fridge; 3–4 months in freezer
120	Storage & Portic	Ground Turkey, Veal, Pork & Lamb	article	3	1–2 days in fridge; 3–4 months in freezer
121	Storage & Portic	Cornd Beef in Pouch with Pickling Juices	article	3	5–7 days in fridge; 1 month drained; 3–4 months in freezer
122	Storage & Portic	Canned Ham (Unopened, Keep Refrigerated)	article	3	6–9 months in fridge; do not freeze
123	Storage & Portic	Canned Ham (Opened)	article	3	3–5 days in fridge; 1–2 months in freezer
124	Storage & Portic	Fully Cooked Ham (Whole)	article	3	7 days in fridge; 1–2 months in freezer
125	Storage & Portic	Fully Cooked Ham (Half)	article	3	3–5 days in fridge; 1–2 months in freezer

120	Storage & Portic: Ham Slices	article	3 3–4 days in fridge; 1–2 months in freezer
121	Storage & Portic: Hot Dogs (Opened)	article	3 1 week in fridge; 1–2 months in freezer
122	Storage & Portic: Hot Dogs (Unopened)	article	3 2 weeks in fridge; 1–2 months in freezer
123	Storage & Portic: Lunch Meats (Opened)	article	3 3–5 days in fridge; 1–2 months in freezer
124	Storage & Portic: Lunch Meats (Unopened)	article	3 2 weeks in fridge; 1–2 months in freezer
131	Storage & Portic: Soup & Stews	article	3 3–4 days in fridge; 2–3 months in freezer
132	Storage & Portic: Bacon	article	3 7 days in fridge; 1 month in freezer
133	Storage & Portic: Sausage (Raw)	article	3 1–2 days in fridge; 1–2 months in freezer
134	Storage & Portic: Sausage (Smoked Links or Patties)	article	3 7 days in fridge; 1–2 months in freezer
135	Storage & Portic: Steaks	article	3 3–5 days in fridge; 6–12 months in freezer
136	Storage & Portic: Chops	article	3 3–5 days in fridge; 4–6 months in freezer
137	Storage & Portic: Roasts	article	3 3–5 days in fridge; 4–12 months in freezer
138	Storage & Portic: Variety Meats	article	3 1–2 days in fridge; 3–4 months in freezer
139	Storage & Portic: Cooked Meat & Meat Dishes	article	3 3–4 days in fridge; 2–3 months in freezer
140	Storage & Portic: Gravy & Meat Broth	article	3 1–2 days in fridge; 2–3 months in freezer
141	Storage & Portic: Whole Chicken or Turkey	article	3 1–2 days in fridge; 1 year in freezer
142	Storage & Portic: Chicken or Turkey Parts	article	3 1–2 days in fridge; 9 months in freezer
143	Storage & Portic: Giblets	article	3 1–2 days in fridge; 3–4 months in freezer
144	Storage & Portic: Fried Chicken	article	3 3–4 days in fridge; 4 months in freezer
145	Storage & Portic: Cooked Poultry Dishes	article	3 3–4 days in fridge; 4–6 months in freezer
146	Storage & Portic: Plain Pieces of Cooked Poultry	article	3 3–4 days in fridge; 4 months in freezer
147	Storage & Portic: Pieces with Broth or Gravy	article	3 3–4 days in fridge; 6 months in freezer
148	Storage & Portic: Chicken Nuggets or Patties	article	3 3–4 days in fridge; 1–3 months in freezer
149	Storage & Portic: Lean Fish	article	3 1–2 days in fridge; 6–8 months in freezer
150	Storage & Portic: Fatty Fish	article	3 1–2 days in fridge; 2–3 months in freezer
151	Storage & Portic: Cooked Fish	article	3 3–4 days in fridge; 4–6 months in freezer
152	Storage & Portic: Smoked Fish	article	3 14 days in fridge; 2 months in freezer
153	Storage & Portic: Fresh Shrimp, Scallops & Shellfish	article	3 1–2 days in fridge; 3–6 months in freezer
154	Storage & Portic: Canned Seafood (Opened)	article	3 3–4 days in fridge; 2 months in freezer
155	Storage & Portic: High vs Low Humidity Drawers	article	3 Use humidity drawers correctly to prolong the life of produce.
156	Storage & Portic: Ethylene Producers	article	3 Keep ethylene-producing fruits away from other produce to slow spoilage.
157	Storage & Portic: Store Root Vegetables Properly	article	3 Potatoes, onions and winter squash prefer cool, dry, dark storage.
158	Storage & Portic: Use the Freezer to Reduce Waste	article	3 Freeze foods you won't use before they spoil to preserve quality and reduce waste.
159	Storage & Portic: Don't Store Milk or Eggs in the Door	article	3 Use the door for condiments and juices, not for milk or eggs.
160	Storage & Portic: Label & Date Containers	article	3 Label foods in fridge and freezer with contents and dates.
161	Storage & Portic: Use Clear Containers	article	3 Store leftovers in clear containers so you can see what's inside.
162	Storage & Portic: First In, First Out	article	3 Rotate foods so older items are used first.
163	Storage & Portic: Plan Portions Wisely	article	3 Cook only what you need to reduce leftovers and maintain food safety.
164	Storage & Portic: Use a Food Scale for Portions	article	3 A kitchen scale helps measure ingredients and control portion sizes.
165	Storage & Portic: Serve Family-Style	article	3 Let diners serve themselves to reduce plate waste.
166	Storage & Portic: Reusing Leftovers	article	3 Transform leftovers into new meals to prevent them from being forgotten.
167	Storage & Portic: Freezer Inventory	article	3 Keep an inventory of your freezer contents and update it regularly.
168	Storage & Portic: Proper Bread Storage	article	3 Store bread at room temperature or in the freezer, not in the fridge.
169	Storage & Portic: Storing Herbs	article	3 Keep herbs fresh by trimming stems and placing them in water or wrapping in damp paper towels.
170	Storage & Portic: Keeping Berries Fresh	article	3 Use a paper towel to absorb moisture and prevent berries from molding.
171	Storage & Portic: Segmenting Bulk Purchases	article	3 Divide bulk purchases into smaller portions before storing or freezing.
172	Storage & Portic: Avoiding Freezer Burn	article	3 Wrap foods tightly and remove air to prevent freezer burn.
173	Storage & Portic: Portioning Leftovers	article	3 Store leftovers in single-serve portions to make reheating easier.
174	Storage & Portic: Maintaining Freezer Temperature	article	3 Keep freezers at 0°F or below for long-term storage.
175	Storage & Portic: Portion Control Tip	article	3 Use smaller plates and bowls to reduce portion sizes.
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190	Compost Basics: What Is Composting?	article	3 Composting is a managed, aerobic decomposition of organic materials.
191	Compost Basics: Why Compost at Home?	article	3 Composting reduces waste, saves money and builds healthy soil.
192	Compost Basics: Composting Reduces Emissions	article	3 Composting keeps food out of landfills and lowers methane emissions.
193	Compost Basics: Compost Builds Soil Health	article	3 Using compost improves soil structure and nutrient content.
194	Compost Basics: Carbon Sequestration	article	3 Compost stores carbon in soil instead of releasing it to the atmosphere.
195	Compost Basics: Backyard Composting: Ingredients	article	3 Combine green and brown materials for successful compost.
196	Compost Basics: What to Compost	article	3 Add fruit and vegetable scraps, coffee grounds, eggshells and yard waste to your pile.
197	Compost Basics: What Not to Compost	article	3 Avoid meat, dairy, oils, and pet waste in home compost piles.
198	Compost Basics: Composting Steps	article	3 Layer greens and browns, keep moist, and turn regularly to aerate.
199	Compost Basics: Avoiding Rodents	article	3 Properly manage your compost pile to deter rodents.
200	Compost Basics: Vermicomposting	article	3 Worm composting uses red worms to break down kitchen scraps.
201	Compost Basics: Benefits of Finished Compost	article	3 Using compost improves plant growth and conserves water.
202	Compost Basics: Options for Composting at Home	article	3 Choose between backyard composting and vermicomposting.
203	Compost Basics: Collecting Food Scraps	article	3 Keep a countertop container for collecting kitchen scraps.
204	Compost Basics: Chopping & Shredding	article	3 Cutting materials into small pieces helps them break down faster.
205	Compost Basics: Maintaining Moisture	article	3 Keep compost as damp as a wrung-out sponge for optimal decomposition.
206	Compost Basics: Turning the Pile	article	3 Regularly aerate your compost to speed decomposition.
207	Compost Basics: Temperature Management	article	3 A hot compost pile accelerates decomposition and kills weed seeds.
208	Compost Basics: Signs of Finished Compost	article	3 Finished compost is dark, crumbly and earthy-smelling.
209	Compost Basics: Using Compost in the Garden	article	3 Incorporate compost into soil or use as mulch.
210	Compost Basics: Compost Tea	article	3 Make compost tea by steeping compost in water to create a nutrient-rich liquid.
211	Compost Basics: Composting in Apartments	article	3 Small-scale options make composting possible in urban settings.
212	Compost Basics: Layering for Balance	article	3 Alternate layers of greens and browns to maintain balance.
213	Compost Basics: Covering Compost	article	3 Cover your pile to retain moisture and heat and prevent pests.
214	Compost Basics: Troubleshooting Odors	article	3 Odors indicate an imbalance; add browns, turn and avoid meats.
215	Compost Basics: Bokashi Composting	article	3 Ferment food scraps anaerobically in a sealed container.
216	Compost Basics: Community Composting	article	3 Participate in local programs to divert food scraps.
217	Compost Basics: Composting & Climate	article	3 Composting helps combat climate change by reducing methane and sequestering carbon.
218	Compost Basics: Rotating Compost Tumblers	article	3 Use tumblers to contain compost and make turning easy.
219	Compost Basics: Diagnosing a Slow Pile	article	3 A slow compost pile may need more greens, moisture or turning.
220	Compost Basics: Harvesting Worm Castings	article	3 Separate worms from finished castings for vermicomposting success.
221	Compost Basics: Indoor Compost Bins	article	3 Use odor-controlling bins and carbon filters for indoor composting.
222	Compost Basics: Compost & Pest Control	article	3 Properly maintained compost does not attract pests.
223	Compost Basics: Composting Pet Hair & Fur	article	3 You can add pet hair and fur to your compost as a nitrogen source.
224	Compost Basics: Leaves & Grass Clippings	article	3 Use leaves and grass clippings as brown and green materials.
225	Compost Basics: Shredded Paper & Cardboard	article	3 Add shredded paper and cardboard as browns to your compost.
226	Compost Basics: Coffee Grounds	article	3 Coffee grounds are green materials; add them sparingly.
227	Compost Basics: Eggshells in Compost	article	3 Crushed eggshells add calcium but break down slowly.
228	Compost Basics: Using Finished Compost Indoors	article	3 Houseplants benefit from a small amount of compost in potting mix.
229	Compost Basics: Green & Brown Ratios	article	3 Aim for a 30:1 carbon to nitrogen ratio in your compost.
230	Compost Basics: Teaching Kids About Compost	article	3 Composting can be a fun educational activity for children.
231	Compost Basics: Community Gardens & Compost	article	3 Many community gardens have shared compost piles for gardeners.
232	Compost Basics: Compost Tip	article	3 Aerate compost regularly to avoid odors.
233	Compost Basics: Compost Tip	article	3 Aerate compost regularly to avoid odors.
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240	Sustainability & Global Food Waste	article	3 One-fifth of food produced is lost or wasted worldwide.
241	Sustainability & Economic Cost of Food Waste	article	3 Food loss and waste costs the global economy roughly \$1 trillion annually.
242	Sustainability & Food Waste & GHG Emissions	article	3 Food loss and waste generate up to 10% of global greenhouse gas emissions.
243	Sustainability & Household Waste Share	article	3 About 60% of food waste occurs at the household level.
244	Sustainability & Hotter Countries & Waste	article	3 Food waste is higher in hotter countries due to storage challenges.
245	Sustainability & U.S. Food Waste	article	3 One-third of all food in the U.S. goes uneaten.
246	Sustainability & Household Waste Disposal	article	3 96% of household food waste ends up in landfills or down the drain.
247	Sustainability & Cost of Wasted Food for Families	article	3 An average family of four loses nearly \$3,000 annually to wasted food.
248	Sustainability & Cash in the Trash	article	3 Cutting food waste can save families up to \$56 per week.
249	Sustainability & Environmental Footprint	article	3 Wasted food squanders land, water, energy and fertilizers.
250	Sustainability & Landfill Methane	article	3 Landfilled food waste is responsible for 58% of methane emissions from landfills.
251	Sustainability & Reducing GHG via Food Waste Reduction	article	3 Cutting waste reduces emissions at all stages of the supply chain.
252	Sustainability & UN SDG 12.3	article	3 Halving global food waste by 2030 is a Sustainable Development Goal.
253	Sustainability & Food Insecurity & Waste	article	3 Food waste coexists with global hunger; reducing waste could feed millions.
254	Sustainability & Resources Embedded in Food	article	3 Food embodies resources such as water, energy and labor.

254	Sustainability &	Portion Control & Sustainability	article	3	Serving appropriate portions reduces waste and conserves resources.
256	Sustainability &	Planning & Shopping	article	3	Meal planning and smart shopping reduce food waste.
257	Sustainability &	Storage & Sustainability	article	3	Proper storage extends shelf life and reduces waste.
258	Sustainability &	Cooking Creativity	article	3	Repurpose leftovers into new dishes to avoid waste.
259	Sustainability &	Donation & Sustainability	article	3	Donating surplus food feeds people and reduces waste.
260	Sustainability &	Composting & Sustainability	article	3	Composting food scraps returns nutrients to the soil and reduces emissions.
261	Sustainability &	Community Action	article	3	Community campaigns can inspire food waste reduction.
262	Sustainability &	Food Waste & Water Use	article	3	Wasted food wastes enough water and energy to supply millions of homes.
263	Sustainability &	Agricultural Land Use	article	3	Food waste uses land equal to California and New York combined.
264	Sustainability &	Reducing Emissions Through Donations	article	3	Donating food avoids emissions from production and disposal.
265	Sustainability &	Support Local Farmers	article	3	Buying locally reduces transportation emissions and supports regional economies.
266	Sustainability &	Seasonal Eating	article	3	Eating seasonal produce reduces waste and environmental impact.
267	Sustainability &	Food Waste vs Aviation Emissions	article	3	Food waste emissions surpass aviation's total emissions.
268	Sustainability &	Food Waste & Climate Justice	article	3	Food waste reduction contributes to climate justice by improving food access.
269	Sustainability &	Policy & Incentives	article	3	Government policies can incentivize food waste reduction.
270	Sustainability &	Education & Awareness	article	3	Educating consumers on food waste has positive impacts.
271	Sustainability &	Tech Solutions	article	3	Apps and digital tools help consumers track and reduce food waste.
272	Sustainability &	Innovations in Packaging	article	3	Smart packaging can extend shelf life and reduce waste.
273	Sustainability &	Circular Economy	article	3	A circular food system minimizes waste by reusing resources.
274	Sustainability &	Measuring Your Waste	article	3	Track your household's waste to identify reduction opportunities.
275	Sustainability &	Food Waste & Methane	article	3	Landfilled food waste produces methane, a potent greenhouse gas.
276	Sustainability &	Links Between Food Waste & Biodiversity	article	3	Reducing food waste helps conserve wildlife habitat.
277	Sustainability &	Goal 12.3 Progress	article	3	Tracking progress toward halving food waste by 2030 is critical.
278	Sustainability &	Food Waste Hierarchy	article	3	Follow EPA's hierarchy: prevention, donation, animal feed, industrial uses, composting, landfill.
279	Sustainability &	Impact of Overbuying	article	3	Buying too much food leads to waste and environmental harm.
280	Sustainability &	Food Date Labels & Waste	article	3	Confusion over date labels contributes to unnecessary waste.
281	Sustainability &	Global GHG of Food Systems	article	3	Agrifood systems emit more than 16 billion tonnes of CO ₂ e annually.
282	Sustainability &	ReFED Solutions	article	3	Implementing food waste solutions could cut U.S. emissions by millions of tonnes.
283	Sustainability &	Food Waste & Hunger Paradox	article	3	Food wasted could feed millions of hungry people.
284	Sustainability &	Role of Consumers	article	3	Consumer choices drive much of the food waste problem and its solution.
285	Sustainability &	Cooking Skills & Waste	article	3	Improving cooking skills helps reduce waste by using ingredients efficiently.
286	Sustainability &	Sharing Resources	article	3	Sharing extra food with neighbors or using community fridges reduces waste.
287	Sustainability &	Cultural Attitudes	article	3	Cultural norms can influence food waste behaviors.
288	Sustainability &	Food Waste vs Food Loss	article	3	Distinguish between food loss (early stages) and food waste (retail & consumer).
289	Sustainability &	Leftover Sharing Apps	article	3	Apps connect people with surplus food to those who want it.
290	Sustainability &	Community Fridges	article	3	Community fridges let people share surplus food and reduce waste.
291	Sustainability &	Reducing Waste Through Preservation	article	3	Techniques like pickling and fermenting extend shelf life and reduce waste.
292	Sustainability &	Eating Ugly Produce	article	3	Buying "ugly" fruits and vegetables reduces waste and supports farmers.
293	Sustainability &	Meal Prep for Waste Reduction	article	3	Cooking in batches and freezing meals prevents ingredient spoilage.
294	Sustainability &	Sharing Leftovers with Friends	article	3	Offer surplus food to friends or neighbors instead of throwing it away.
295	Sustainability &	Food Bank Support Beyond Donations	article	3	Volunteering and financial support help food banks operate.
297	Sustainability &	Eating Nose-to-Tail	article	3	Using all edible parts of animals reduces waste and honors the animal.
298	Sustainability &	Diet Diversity & Sustainability	article	3	Eating diverse foods supports resilient food systems and reduces pressure on a few crops.
299	Sustainability &	Cooking with Scraps	article	3	Vegetable peels and stems can be used in stocks and soups.
300	Sustainability &	Grow Your Own Herbs	article	3	Growing herbs at home reduces waste from unused bunches.
301	Sustainability &	Educate Kids About Food Waste	article	3	Teaching children about food waste fosters lifelong sustainable habits.

content	thumbnail	tags	order
The CDC emphasizes four key steps to food safety: Clean, Separate, Cook, and Chill. The first step—Clean—means washing your hands with soap and water for at least 20 seconds before, during and after preparing food and before eating. It also means washing utensils		food-safety;clean;handwashing	0
The CDC advises keeping raw meat, poultry, seafood and eggs separate from other foods at all times. In the grocery cart and refrigerator, store raw or marinating meat and poultry in sealed containers so juices don't drip onto other foods. Use one cutting board or plate f		food-safety;separate;cross-contamination	0
Cooking food properly means heating it to a temperature high enough to kill harmful bacteria. The CDC notes that the only way to know if food is safely cooked is to use a food thermometer. For example, whole cuts of beef, veal, lamb and pork should reach 145 °F and n		food-safety;cook;thermometer	0
Bacteria multiply quickly in the "Danger Zone" between 40°F and 140°F. The CDC advises refrigerating perishable foods within two hours—within one hour if temperatures exceed 90°F. Keep your refrigerator at 40°F or below and your freezer at 0°F or below. Store hot f		food-safety;chill;storage	0
The CDC identifies several foods that are more likely to contain harmful germs. These include raw or undercooked poultry, meat, seafood and eggs; raw sprouts; unwashed fruits and vegetables; cut melon; unpasteurized milk, juice or soft cheese; and raw dough or batt		food-safety;risk-food;raw	0
Always wash your hands before, during and after preparing food and before eating. Use soap and warm or cold water and scrub for at least 20 seconds. Be sure to wash after handling raw meat, chicken, poultry, seafood, flour or eggs. Germs can live on many surfaces i		food-safety;handwashing;clean	0
After preparing each food item—especially raw meat, poultry or seafood—clean cutting boards, utensils and countertops with hot, soapy water. Rinse fresh fruits and vegetables under running water. Keeping kitchen surfaces clean minimizes the risk of cross-contaminati		food-safety;clean;utensils	0
Even if you plan to peel or cut produce, rinse it under running water first. Use clean hands to gently rub the surface to remove dirt and microbes. For firm produce like melons or cucumbers, use a clean produce brush. Dry with a clean cloth or paper towel to further redu		food-safety;produce;clean	0
The CDC warns that raw chicken is ready to cook and does not need washing. Washing raw poultry can splash bacteria onto sinks, countertops and other foods. If you choose to wash chicken, do so carefully to minimize splashing, but the safest option is to avoid wash		food-safety;raw-chicken;cross-contamination	0
When grocery shopping, place raw meat, poultry and seafood in a separate area of the cart or in plastic bags to prevent juices from dripping onto other foods. At home, store raw or marinating meat, poultry and seafood in sealed containers or wrapped securely so juices		food-safety;grocery;storage	0
Cross-contamination can occur when juices from raw meat, poultry or seafood touch foods that won't be cooked. Use one cutting board or plate for raw meat and a separate one for produce, bread and other ready-to-eat foods. This simple practice helps prevent food		food-safety;cutting-board;cross-contamination	0
Colour and texture alone can be deceiving. Use a food thermometer to check that foods reach safe internal temperatures: 145°F for whole cuts of beef, pork, lamb and fish (let meat rest for 3 minutes), 160°F for ground meats and 165°F for poultry, casseroles and left		food-safety;thermometer;cooking	0
Different foods require different minimum internal temperatures to destroy harmful bacteria. Whole cuts of beef, veal, lamb and pork should reach 145°F and rest for 3 minutes; fish should reach 145°F or be cooked until flesh is opaque and flakes easily; ground meats su		food-safety;safe-temperature;cooking	0
Microwave ovens can cook unevenly. Follow recommended cooking and standing times, stirring or rotating food to avoid cold spots. Check your microwave's wattage (usually listed inside the door or in the manual) to determine proper cooking times. High-wattage micro		food-safety;microwave;cooking	0
Bacteria grow rapidly between 40°F and 140°F. Keep your refrigerator set to 40°F or below and your freezer at 0°F or below. Never leave perishable foods out at room temperature for more than two hours (one hour if the temperature is above 90°F). Refrigerate leftovers		food-safety;refrigerator;storage	0
The CDC recommends thawing food safely in the refrigerator, in cold water changed every 30 minutes, or in the microwave. Do not thaw food on the counter because parts of the food can reach the "Danger Zone" while the interior remains frozen. Safe thawing prevents		food-safety;thawing;freezing	0
Leftovers can be a delicious way to reduce waste, but they need proper handling. Refrigerate leftovers within two hours in shallow containers. Use them within 3–4 days and reheat to 165°F before eating. If in doubt, throw it out to avoid foodborne i		food-safety;leftovers;storage	0
Bacteria multiply rapidly at temperatures between 40°F and 140°F. Avoid leaving perishable foods in this "Danger Zone." Keep hot foods hot (above 140°F) and cold foods cold (below 40°F). Refrigerate or freeze perishable food promptly and reheat leftovers thoroughly		food-safety;danger-zone;temperature	0
Large portions of hot food can take too long to cool, allowing bacteria to grow. Divide warm or hot food into several clean, shallow containers for faster cooling and refrigerate immediately. It's safe to put small portions of hot food directly into the fridge, as they chill quick		food-safety;hot-food;cooling	0
Certain people are more susceptible to severe illness from foodborne pathogens. Children under five, pregnant women, adults over 65 and those with weakened immune systems should be especially careful about food safety. They should avoid high-risk foods, ensure th		food-safety;risk-groups;vulnerable	0
Some foods are more likely to cause food poisoning. The CDC suggests selecting safer alternatives, such as pasteurized milk and juices instead of unpasteurized products, cooked sprouts instead of raw sprouts, and cooked eggs rather than raw or lightly cooked eggs.		food-safety;safe-choices;food-selection	0
Foodborne illnesses can cause diarrhea, stomach pain or cramps, nausea, vomiting and fev		food-safety;symptoms;illness	0
You can't judge a burger's doneness by its color or juices. According to food safety experts, using a food thermometer is the only way to know if meats and casseroles have reached temperatures that kill dangerous bacteria. Insert the thermometer into the thickest part o		food-safety;thermometer;doneness	0
Microwave ovens vary widely in power. Look inside the door or in the manual to find your microwave's wattage. Higher-wattage microwaves cook faster, so use the minimum recommended time. Low-wattage units require the maximum time. Always let microwaved foods		food-safety;microwave;wattage	0
Cleaning and sanitizing are different. Cleaning removes dirt and crumbs, while sanitizing kills or reduces bacteria to safe levels. After washing surfaces with hot, soapy water, apply a kitchen sanitizer or diluted bleach solution to disinfect. This two-step process keeps fo		food-safety;cleaning;sanitizing	0
Sponges absorb and retain moisture and food particles, creating an ideal environment for bacteria. Disinfect sponges every few days by microwaving them (wet) for one minute or running them through the dishwasher. Replace sponges frequently and consider using dish		food-safety;sponges;cleaning	0
Kitchen towels can spread bacteria. Use one towel exclusively for drying hands and another for drying dishes or produce. Replace and launder towels often in hot water to keep them sanitary. Avoid wiping hands on or use them to prevent c		food-safety;towels;hygiene	0
Food date labels can be confusing. A "sell-by" date tells the store how long to display the product; it is not a safety date. "Best-by" or "best if used by" indicates when a product is at peak quality. A "use-by" date is the last recommended date for the product's quality. Fo		food-safety;date-labels;expiration	0
The lower shelves of your refrigerator are the coldest and safest place to store meat, poultry and fish. Keeping them on the bottom prevents juices from dripping onto ready-to-eat foods stored below. The door is the warmest part of the fridge, so avoid storing milk or egg		food-safety;fridge;cross-contamination	0
For dry goods like grains, flour and snacks, store them in airtight containers. Label containers with contents and dates to keep track of freshness. Sealed containers prevent moisture and pests from getting in and help reduce food waste		food-safety;storage;containers	0
Freeze food you won't eat in time, such as bread, sliced fruit, meat or leftovers. Label items with the contents and date. Freezing keeps food safe indefinitely, but quality may decline over time. Use freezer-safe packaging to prevent freezer burn and maintain fl		food-safety;freezing;storage	0
Food that's past its prime can often be transformed into delicious dishes. Use produce odds and ends in soups or stews, stale bread for croutons or French toast, wilted greens in stir fries, and overripe fruit in smoothies or baked goods. Creativity in the kitchen reduces		food-safety;leftovers;creativity	0
Aim to cook only what you'll eat to reduce leftovers. When serving, use smaller plates to encourage reasonable portion sizes. If leftovers remain, refrigerate or freeze them promptly in clear, labeled containers. Proper portioning prevents food from lingering at unsafe temp		food-safety;portions;waste-reduction	0
Hot food left out to cool slowly can enter the "Danger Zone." Divide large portions into shallow containers to speed cooling and refrigerate promptly. Stirring soups or sauces in an ice bath can also help bring the temperature down quickly. Cover loosely to allow heat to		food-safety;cooling;leftovers	0
Insert the thermometer into the thickest part of the meat without touching bone, fat or gristle. For casseroles or mixed dishes, place in the center. When cooking thin foods like burgers, insert from the side. Always clean the thermometer after each use to avoid cross-cont		food-safety;thermometer;placement	0
Keeping food safe means keeping it out of the Danger Zone. Refrigerate perishable foods at or below 40°F and keep hot foods above 140°F. When transporting food, use insulated coolers and ice packs. Don't leave food out for more than two hours, or one hour if it's ab		food-safety;danger-zone;temperature	0
Cold-water thawing is faster than refrigerator thawing but needs attention. Submerge frozen food in a leak-proof plastic bag in cold water and change the water every 30 minutes. Cook the food immediately after thawing. Never thaw meat on the counter, as this allows ba		food-safety;thawing;cold-water	0
Food recalls can occur due to contamination or undeclared allergens. If you have a recalled product, throw it away and clean and sanitize surfaces and containers that may have contacted it. Do not taste the food to see if it's safe. Stay informed of recalls through trusted		food-safety;recalls;discard	0
Raw dough or batter may contain dangerous pathogens. Flour can harbour E. coli, and raw eggs can carry Salmonella. Avoid tasting raw cookie dough or cake batter. Bake or cook foods before tasting, and teach children not to eat raw dough		food-safety;raw-dough;bacteria	0
Fruits like bananas, apples, pears, stone fruits and avocados emit ethylene gas as they ripen. This gas can cause nearby produce to spoil faster. Store ethylene-producing fruits away from vegetables and non-ethylene-producing fruits to extend shelf l		food-safety;produce;storage	0
Most refrigerators have a humidity drawer for vegetables that tend to wilt (leafy greens, carrots, broccoli) and the low-humidity drawer for fruits and vegetables that tend to rot or mold (mushrooms, peppers). Adjusting humidity helps pre		food-safety;humidity;produce	0
Not all produce belongs in the refrigerator. Store potatoes, winter squash, onions and garlic in a cool, dry, dark and well-ventilated place. Keep them in breathable bags or baskets, not sealed containers. Avoid storing potatoes with onions, as they can cause each other t		food-safety;root-vegetables;storage	0
Keep milk, eggs and perishable items on the inner shelves where temperatures are coldest. The door experiences temperature fluctuations as it's opened and closed, making it better for condiments, juices and other foods with preservatives		food-safety;refrigerator;door	0
Place raw meat, poultry and fish on the bottom shelf or in a dedicated meat drawer. This keeps any accidental drips from contaminating ready-to-eat foods. Always place these items in leak-proof containers or on trays to catch juices		food-safety;fridge;meat-storage	0
When you store leftovers or freeze food, label the container with what's inside and the date. This simple habit prevents forgotten mystery containers and helps you use food before it spoils. Use a piece of painter's tape and a marker for easy removal later.		food-safety;labeling;organization	0
Moisture encourages mold growth on delicate fruits. Keep berries, cherries and grapes dry until you're ready to eat them. Store them in their original containers or breathable containers in the refrigerator and rinse just before consumption		food-safety;berries;storage	0
Many refrigerators don't display the actual internal temperature. Place an appliance thermometer in your fridge (aim for 40°F or below) and freezer (0°F or below) to ensure food stays safely cold. Check periodically to make s		food-safety;thermometer;refrigerator	0
Because grinding distributes bacteria throughout the meat, ground beef, pork and lamb must reach at least 160°F, and ground poultry must reach 165°F. Use a thermometer to verify doneness and avoid eating undercooked burgers or meat		food-safety;ground-meat;cooking	0
Properly cooked fish is both safe and delicious. The CDC recommends cooking fish with fins to an internal temperature of 145°F. If you don't have a thermometer, check that the flesh is opaque and separates easily with a fork. Undercooked fish may harbor parasites or		food-safety;fish;cooking	0
Leftovers and casseroles require thorough reheating. Heat them to 165°F, stirring halfway through to ensure even heating. This kills any bacteria that may have grown during storage. Use a thermometer to verify the temperature in the thickest part of the d		food-safety;leftovers;reheating	0
Reusable cloth or plastic grocery bags can accumulate bacteria from meats and produce. Wash reusable bags in hot water with detergent after each use. Designate separate bags for raw meats and produce, and avoid storing them in warm car trunks where bacteria ca		food-safety;reusable-bags;cleaning	0
Marinate meat, poultry and seafood in the refrigerator to keep them below 40°F. Discard any leftover marinades that have touched raw meat or boil them before using as a sauce. Using clean utensils and containers prevents bacteria from spreading.		food-safety;marinating;safety	0
For picnics, use insulated coolers with ice packs to keep cold foods at safe temperatures. Keep the cooler in the shade and avoid opening it frequently. Keep hot foods in insulated containers. Discard perishable foods left out for more than two hours (one hour if it's abov		food-safety;picnic;outdoor	0
After shopping, go straight home or bring a cooler if you have other errands. In warm weather, perishable foods can quickly reach the Danger Zone in the car. Place cold items together to keep them chilled longer, and refrigerate or freeze them as soon as you get home.		food-safety;groceries;transport	0
Food that spoils due to improper handling or storage must be discarded. By practicing proper cleaning, separation, cooking and refrigeration, you not only protect yourself from foodborne illness but also extend the life of your food and reduce waste.		food-safety;waste-reduction;safety	0
Perishable lunch items like sandwiches with meat or dairy should be kept below 40°F. Use an insulated lunch bag with a frozen gel pack or frozen water bottle. If refrigeration is available at work or school, store the lunch in the fridge until it's time to eat.		food-safety;lunch;ice-pack	0
Children should know not to leave their lunches in warm places like on top of lockers or near heaters. Encourage them to throw away leftover perishables at the end of the day. Provide an ice pack for foods that need to stay cold, such as yo		food-safety;school;children	0
Pets and pet food can carry germs like Salmonella and Campylobacter. Always wash your hands with soap and water after touching animals, their food, bowls or toys. Keep pets off kitchen counters and away from food preparation areas to reduce contamination risks.		food-safety;pets;handwashing	0
After washing cutting boards with hot, soapy water, sanitize them with a solution of 1 tablespoon of unscented liquid chlorine bleach per gallon of water. Let the solution sit on the surface for a few minutes and rinse with clear water. Replace heavily worn or grooved boar		food-safety;cutting-boards;sanitizing	0
Overfilled refrigerators can hinder air circulation, causing uneven cooling. Keep your fridge organized and avoid overcrowding shelves. Store leftovers at eye level so you remember to use them. Rotate older items to the front and newer items to the back.		food-safety;fridge;organization	0
The EPA notes that large manufacturers, supermarket chains, wholesalers, farmers, food brokers and community drives typically donate food to food banks. Restaurants, caterers, corporate dining rooms, hotels and other food establishments also donate perishable and		donation;food-donor;community	0
Schools, community organizations and individuals can play a role by collecting and donating unspoiled, healthy food or participating in local food rescue efforts		donation;schools;community	0
The Bill Emerson Good Samaritan Food Donation Act protects donors from liability when they donate food in good faith. As long as the donor has not acted with negligence or intentional misconduct, they are not liable for illness or injury caused by the donated food. The donation-good-samaritan		donation;good-samaritan;law	0
In January 2023, the Good Samaritan Food Donation Act was updated to provide liability protection for qualified direct donors who donate food directly to individuals. This change encourages retailers, restaurants and individuals to share food with those in need without		donation;law;2023-update	0
The EPA emphasizes learning about food safety basics or contacting your state or local health department for guidelines on safely donating food.		donation;safety;health-department	0
When donating food, leave items in their original packaging with intact seals. Avoid donating open or partially used packages. For fresh produce, use food-grade containers or bags that keep items clean and free from contaminants. Packaging integrity helps recipients tr		donation;packaging;integrity	0
Donated food should be safe and high quality. Do not donate food that shows signs of spoilage, such as mold, off odors or unusual textures. Foods past their "use-by" date may not be safe. Only donate items that you would feel comfortable eating yourself.		donation;food-quality;safety	0
Prepared foods from restaurants, caterers and events can be donated to feed people in need. They must be handled with care: cooled to 41°F or below within two hours, stored in shallow, sealed containers and labelled with preparation dates. Reheat donated prepared		donation;prepared-food;restaurants	0
Clear labeling helps recipient organizations handle and distribute donated food safely. Label containers with the date of preparation, a description of contents and any common allergens (e.g., nuts, dairy, soy). This enables agencies to use foods within safe timeframes an		donation;labeling;allergens	0
Maintaining safe temperatures is crucial when transporting food for donation. Keep cold foods at or below 40°F using coolers and ice packs, and keep hot foods at or above 140°F using insulated carriers. Rapidly deliver perishable foods to prevent bacterial growth.		donation;transport;temperature	0
Home-canned foods may not reach temperatures necessary to destroy botulism spores and other pathogens. For safety reasons, many food banks and shelters do not accept home-canned foods. Donate commercially canned goods or professionally prepared foods ins		donation;home-canned;safety	0
Nonperishable items like canned goods, pasta, rice and cereal have long shelf lives and are easy to store. They can be distributed over time without risk of spoilage. When donating, consider adding shelf-stable proteins (peanut butter, canned beans, tuna), grains and cal		donation;nonperishable;food-banks	0
Many food banks accept fresh produce. Donate fruits and vegetables that are ripe but not overripe, free of mold and bruises. Wash produce lightly to remove soil and pack in clean, ventilated containers. Avoid donating produce that is cut or peeled, as it requires refriger		donation;produce;fresh	0
Some food banks have minimum donation requirements or prefer donations of a certain size to streamline sorting and distribution		donation;organization;guidelines	0
Food banks collect nonperishable foods in warehouses and distribute them to families through pantries, soup kitchens and other agencies		donation;where-to-donate;food-bank	0
Technology makes donating food easier. MealConnect connects donors to local food banks via an app		donation;apps;rescue	0
Food rescue organizations often rely on volunteers to pick up and deliver donations. Becoming a volunteer helps keep surplus food out of landfills and ensures it reaches people in need. Contact local organizations to learn about opportunities.		donation;volunteering;community	0
The Harvard Food and Policy Clinic notes that companies can access enhanced tax deductions for donating food		donation;tax-benefits;business	0
Help increase food donations by encouraging local businesses, grocers and schools to donate surplus food		donation;community;outreach	0
Create a schedule for donation pick-ups from your organization or business on a weekly, biweekly or monthly basis		donation;pickups;organization	0
Food donation regulations require that donated food be wholesome and unadulterated. Do not donate foods that have been recalled, have tampered packaging or show signs of spoilage. Check expiration dates and discard anything that is unsafe.		donation;wholesome;quality	0
Prepared hot foods intended for donation must be cooled to 41°F or below within two hours and stored in shallow pans. Rapid cooling prevents bacterial growth. Use ice baths, cold paddles or blast chillers to cool foods quickly and label containers with preparation time		donation;cooling;prepared-food	0
Recipient agencies may require documentation that foods were kept at safe temperatures. Use a thermometer to monitor and record temperatures of hot and cold foods during storage and transport. Accurate logs help ensure food safety and compliance.		donation;temperature-logs;documentation	0
If you are donating hot foods that will be served directly, maintain them at 140°F or above using insulated containers or warmers. Avoid leaving hot foods at room temperature, which can encourage bacterial growth. Deliver and serve promptly.		donation;hot-food;holding	0
Cold foods must remain at or below 40°F until they reach the recipient. Use refrigerators, coolers or insulated containers with ice packs. Monitor temperatures and minimize time that foods spend outside safe refrigeration.		donation;cold-food;holding	0
People preparing food for donation should wash hands thoroughly, wear clean clothing and use gloves when appropriate. Avoid handling food when ill. Good hygiene ensures that donated food remains safe and wholesome.		donation;hygiene;handlers	0
Farmers often have produce that is unsold or imperfect. Volunteer gleaning programs harvest this food and deliver it to food banks and pantries. It's a great way to reduce waste and increase access to fresh fruits and vegetables.		donation;gleaning;farmers	0
Under the Good Samaritan Food Donation Act, individuals who glean produce from fields for donation are protected from liability as long as they act without negligence or intentional misconduct		donation;gleaning;legal	0
States and localities may have specific regulations regarding what foods can be donated, handling requirements and labeling. Contact your local health department or food safety authority to ensure compliance with applicable laws and guidelines before donating.		donation;regulations;local	0
Crops that are too small, irregularly shaped or blemished may be rejected by retailers but are still nutritious. Programs like gleaning and produce rescue enable farmers to donate these fruits and vegetables to those in need.		donation;farm;surplus	0
Events often result in large quantities of leftover food. Coordinate with caterers and local food rescue organizations to safely package, chill and donate leftovers. Encourage event organizers to plan for donations ahead of time.		donation;events;leftovers	0
Donors must handle food properly—maintaining correct temperatures, using clean equipment and avoiding contamination—to be covered by Good Samaritan protections. Intentional misconduct or gross negligence can void legal protections.		donation;negligence;legal	0
Certain foods—like raw seafood, shellfish and unpasteurized dairy—may not be suitable for donation because they require stringent temperature control and can pose health risks. Donate only foods you can handle safely.		donation;restricted-foods;safety	0
Businesses donating food should educate employees about proper food handling, packaging and transport. Training helps ensure donations are safe and reduces liability. Provide clear instructions and checklists for staff to follow.		donation;training;employees	0
Break down large pans or containers of food into smaller packages that are easier for agencies to distribute and recipients to use. Smaller portions reduce waste, ensure even cooling and allow families to take only what they need.		donation;portioning;distribution	0
Dairy products must be kept cold at all times. Donate them before their expiration or "use-by" dates and ensure they have been stored at or below 40°F. Many food banks welcome donations of milk, cheese and yogurt as long as they are unopened and within date.		donation;dairy;perishable	0
Fresh bread and baked goods are often in demand at food banks. Check for mold or spoilage before donating. Pack items securely to avoid crushing and deliver promptly. Day-old bread is usually accepted, but avoid donating stale or dried-out products.		donation;baked-goods;bread	0
Don't donate cans that are badly dented or bulging, as they may be contaminated. Ensure that labels are intact and readable. Canned goods are safe to donate long past the "best-by" date if stored properly.		donation;canned;quality	0
Infant formula has strict expiration dates for safety and nutritional reasons. Only donate sealed containers of formula well before the expiration date. If in doubt, consult the recipient organization about their policies.		donation;infant-formula;expiration	0
Common allergens include peanuts, tree nuts, dairy, eggs, wheat, soy, fish and shellfish. Keep allergen-containing foods separate from others and clearly label them. This prevents cross-contact and helps agencies inform recipients about potential allergens.		donation;allergens;labeling	0
Each food bank may have unique needs and restrictions. Contact local organizations to learn what they need most (e.g., protein sources, whole grains) and what they cannot accept. Tailoring your donations to their requirements increases your impact.		donation;coordination;food-banks	0
Food banks prefer receiving safe, high-quality items that clients will enjoy. Donate foods that are nutritious, appealing and culturally appropriate. Don't use food banks as a disposal method for unwanted items.		donation;quality;ethics	0
MealConnect, operated by Feeding America, allows individuals and businesses to post surplus food items that local food banks can claim. This technology simplifies the donation process and reduces food waste		donation;mealconnect;technology	0
AmpleHarvest.org helps home gardeners find local food pantries that accept fresh produce		donation;garden;produce	0
The Food Rescue Locator is a directory of organizations that collect, prepare and distribute donated food		donation;locator;directory	0
The Global Food Donation Policy Atlas provides information on food donation laws and policies in participating countries		donation;global;policy	0
Food that has been served to a customer cannot be donated due to potential contamination. Only donate unused food that has not been served directly to individuals. Foods from buffets must remain untouched and within safe temperature ranges to qualify for donation.		donation;plate-waste;safety	0
Donations should be picked up as soon as possible, especially perishable items. Coordinate with recipient organizations to schedule pick-ups at times when they can receive and store the food immediately. Prompt transfers keep food safe and reduce spoilage.		donation;timing;logistics	0
Food banks and shelters follow strict safety protocols. If donated food is spoiled, improperly packaged or unsafe, it will be discarded to protect clients. Don't be offended if items are refused—safety is the priority.		donation;disposal;safety	0
Eggs are best kept in their original carton in the main body of the refrigerator, not the door. They stay fresh for 3–5 weeks. Avoid freezing eggs in the shell; instead, beat yolks and whites together and freeze in an airtight container		storage;eggs;refrigeration	0
After cooking, cook eggs quickly under cold water, then store in the refrigerator for up to one week. Avoid freezing hard-cooked eggs, as they become tough and watery		storage;eggs;cooked	0
Opened liquid pasteurized egg products should be used within three days and kept refrigerated. Freezing is not recommended		storage;eggs;pasteurized	0
Unopened liquid egg substitutes can stay fresh in the refrigerator for about 10 days. They may be frozen for up to one year; however, check manufacturer's instructions		storage;eggs;substitutes	0
Commercially prepared frozen dinners and casseroles should remain frozen until ready to cook. For best quality, use them within 3–4 months. Follow package instructions for cooking.		storage;frozen;prepared-meals	0
Homemade or store-prepared salads containing eggs, chicken, tuna, ham or pasta should be refrigerated and eaten within 3–5 days. These salads do not freeze well and may separate or become watery		storage;salads;prepared	0
Stuffed foods or chicken breasts with dressing should be cooked within one day. Freezing is not recommended because stuffing may become soggy and unsafe		storage;meat;stuffed	0
Meals prepared and cooked by stores should be consumed within 3–4 days. Freezing may alter texture and quality		storage;prepared-meals;refrigeration	0
Commercial vacuum-packed dinners with a USDA seal can be stored unopened in the refrigerator for up to two weeks. Freezing is not necessary or recommended		storage;vacuum-packed;refrigeration	0
Raw hamburger and stew meats should be used within 1–2 days when refrigerated. For longer storage, freeze them for 3–4 months. Thaw in the refrigerator or cook from frozen		storage;meat;hamburger	0
Ground poultry and other ground meats should be cooked within 1–2 days. Freeze for up to 3–4 months to maintain quality		storage;ground-meat;freezer	0
Corned beef stored in its pickling liquid can last 5–7 days in the refrigerator. Once drained, it can be refrigerated for up to one month or frozen for 3–4 months		storage;corned-beef;refrigeration	0
Unopened canned ham labeled "Keep Refrigerated" can last 6–9 months in the refrigerator. Freezing is not recommended, as it may affect texture		storage;ham;canned	0
Once opened, canned ham should be refrigerated and used within 3–5 days. You can freeze leftover ham for 1–2 months for longer storage		storage;ham;opened	0
A whole fully cooked ham stays good in the refrigerator for about 7 days. Freeze slices or portions for 1–2 months for longer storage		storage;ham;whole	0
Half hams should be eaten within 3–5 days. Wrap tightly and freeze for 1–2 months if you can't finish it in time		storage;ham;half	0

By cooking and serving only what will be eaten, you prevent leftovers from spoiling. Portion control reduces food waste and helps conserve the resources used to produce food	https://www.epa.gov/recycle/preventing-wasted-food-home#:~:text=jam%2Fally%20from%20a	sustainability:portions;waste	0
Plan meals, make shopping lists and buy only what you need. Avoid impulse purchases and bulk buying unless you plan to portion and freeze. Thoughtful shopping prevents food from spoiling before it's eaten.		sustainability:planning;shopping	0
Storing foods at correct temperatures and humidity levels prevents spoilage. Use your fridge's humidity drawers appropriately, keep fridge temperatures at 40°F or below and freeze items you can't use in time	https://www.epa.gov/recycle/preventing-wasted-food-home#:~:text=jam%2Fally%20from%20a	sustainability:storage;tips	0
Use leftover ingredients creatively: make soups from wilted vegetables, smoothies from overripe fruit and croutons from stale bread	https://www.epa.gov/recycle/preventing-wasted-food-home#:~:text=and%20vegetable%20scraps%20can%20be	sustainability:leftovers;creativity	0
Donate safe, unspoiled food to local food banks and rescue organizations. Donation nourishes people and diverts food from landfills, supporting community wellbeing and environmental sustainability	https://www.epa.gov/sustainable-management-food-food-donation-ba	sustainability:donation;community	0
Composting keeps food scraps out of landfills, reducing methane emissions, and produces nutrient-rich compost that improves soil health	https://www.epa.gov/recycle/composting-home#:~:text=Compost%20your%20scraps%20for%20a%20Health%20Plan	sustainability:composting;climate	0
EPA boosts help communities design behavior change campaigns to prevent food waste	https://www.epa.gov/recycle/preventing-wasted-food-home#:~:text=Tools%20for%20Your%20Home%20and	Your%20Community. Community efforts amplify individual actions and create shared responsibility	0
In the U.S., annual food loss and waste consumes enough water and energy to supply more than 50 million homes	https://www.epa.gov/recycle/preventing-wasted-food-home#:~:text=to%20California%20and%20New%20York	Reducing waste conserves these essential resources	0
The land required to grow lost and wasted food in the U.S. is equivalent to the combined area of California and New York	https://www.epa.gov/recycle/preventing-wasted-food-home#:~:text=to%20California%20and%20New%20York	Reducing waste can free up land for conservation	0
When surplus food is donated and eaten, it replaces the need to produce additional food and prevents methane emissions from landfilled waste. Donation is a powerful way to reduce the climate impact of food waste.		sustainability:donation;emissions	0
Purchasing food from local farmers reduces the distance food travels, cutting transportation emissions. Local produce is often fresher, and you can buy only what you need, reducing waste.		sustainability:local;economy	0
Seasonal produce is often harvested at peak ripeness and has a lower environmental footprint. It tends to be fresher, tastier and less likely to spoil quickly. Eating seasonally reduces reliance on storage and long-distance transport.		sustainability:seasonal;produce	0
Food waste generates greenhouse gas emissions that are almost five times the total emissions of the aviation sector	https://www.wfp.org/stories/5-facts-about-food-waste-and-hunger#:~:text=3	compared to 20% of the aviation sector. Reducing food waste can therefore deliver significant climate benefits	0
Tackling food waste helps address hunger and reduces emissions that disproportionately affect vulnerable communities. Donating surplus food and composting support environmental and social justice.		sustainability:justice;equity	0
Policy tools such as enhanced tax deductions for food donation, liability protections and public awareness campaigns encourage businesses and individuals to reduce waste and donate surplus food.		sustainability:policy;incentives	0
Awareness campaigns and educational programs help consumers understand the environmental and economic costs of food waste and offer practical tips to reduce it.		sustainability:education;awareness	0
Apps can track expiration dates, suggest recipes for ingredients on hand and facilitate food sharing or donation. Using technology makes it easier to plan meals, store foods properly and prevent waste.		sustainability:technology;apps	0
Developments in packaging – such as edible coatings, breathable films and temperature indicators – help extend the shelf life of perishable foods and reduce spoilage.		sustainability:packaging;innovation	0
A circular economy for food aims to keep resources in use for as long as possible through composting, recycling and reusing. It replaces the take-make-waste model with one that closes loops and reduces environmental impacts.		sustainability:circular-economy;systems	0
Keep a log of discarded food for a week to see what you're throwing away. Use this information to adjust shopping and cooking habits, helping to cut waste and save money.		sustainability:measurement;tracking	0
When food decomposes anaerobically in landfills, it releases methane – a greenhouse gas 28 times more potent than CO ₂ over a 100-year period. Composting or donating food avoids methane emissions	https://www.epa.gov/recycle/preventing-wasted-food-home#:~:text=to%20achieve%20year%20and%20near%20	sustainability:methane;climate	0
By minimizing the land needed to produce wasted food, we can preserve natural habitats and biodiversity. Less land conversion reduces pressure on forests and wildlife.		sustainability:biodiversity;conservation	0
Many countries and organizations are measuring food waste to assess progress towards SDG 12.3. Transparent data collection helps identify hotspots and monitor effectiveness of interventions.		sustainability:progress;monitoring	0
EPA's food recovery hierarchy prioritizes actions to prevent and divert food waste: reduce surplus at the source, donate excess food, feed animals, use waste for industrial purposes (e.g., anaerobic digestion), compost remaining scraps, and send the least amount possible to landfills.		sustainability:hierarchy;EPA	0
Overbuying often results in produce spoiling before you can use it. Plan meals, shop with a list and avoid impulse purchases to prevent waste and save resources.		sustainability:overbuying;planning	0
Consumers often throw out food based on "sell-by," "best-by" and "use-by" dates, even when it's still safe. Understanding these labels and using your senses can help prevent premature disposal	https://www.epa.gov/recycle/preventing-wasted-food-home#:~:text=of%20	sustainability:labels;education	0
According to the FAO, global agricultural systems emit 16.2 billion tonnes of CO ₂ e annually	https://www.fao.org/statistics/highlights-archived/highlights-detail/greenhouse-gas-emissions-from-agricultural-systems-global-regional-and-country-trends-2000-2022/en?utm_source=refEED&utm_medium=article&utm_campaign=refEED&utm_term=refEED	sustainability:FAO;emissions	0
ReFED estimates that fully implementing food waste reduction solutions could reduce U.S. greenhouse gas emissions by 79 million metric tonnes of CO ₂ e each year	https://www.refed.org/food-waste/climate-and-resources/#:~:text=CO2e%20each%20year%20and%20near%20	sustainability:ReFED;solutions	0
While millions suffer from food insecurity, a vast amount of food is wasted. Redistribution of edible food through donations could significantly alleviate hunger	https://www.wfp.org/stories/5-facts-about-food-waste-and-hunger#:~:text=Global%20hunger%20and%20	sustainability:paradox;hunger	0
Consumers influence the amount of food produced and wasted. By planning meals, storing food correctly, understanding date labels and valuing leftovers, individuals can significantly reduce waste and drive demand for more sustainable practices.		sustainability:consumer;behavior	0
Learning basic cooking skills, like knife techniques and recipe flexibility, allows you to use up ingredients and avoid letting produce spoil. Cooking confidence encourages people to experiment with leftovers.		sustainability:skills;cooking	0
Community fridges and local food sharing platforms enable people to give away surplus food rather than letting it go to waste. Sharing builds community ties and reduces environmental impacts.		sustainability:sharing;community	0
Some cultures encourage large portions or view leftovers negatively, contributing to waste. Promoting a culture of respect for food and celebrating dishes made from leftovers can shift attitudes and reduce waste.		sustainability:culture;behaviors	0
Food loss occurs during production, post-harvest and processing stages, often due to infrastructure and storage issues. Food waste occurs at retail and consumer levels due to overbuying, poor planning and discard of edible food. Solutions differ for each stage.		sustainability:food-loss;terminology	0
Apps like Olio and Too Good To Go allow individuals and restaurants to share or sell surplus food at reduced prices. These platforms reduce waste and provide access to affordable food.		sustainability:apps;sharing	0
Community fridges are publicly accessible refrigerators where individuals and businesses can leave surplus food for anyone to take. They help reduce waste, strengthen communities and improve food security.		sustainability:community;fridge;sharing	0
Preserving foods through methods like pickling, fermenting and canning extends their shelf life and adds variety to meals. This reduces waste by allowing you to enjoy surplus produce later.		sustainability:preservation;techniques	0
Imperfect produce tastes just as good but is often discarded due to cosmetic flaws. Buying and eating ugly produce prevents waste and helps farmers sell more of their harvest.		sustainability:imperfect;produce	0
Prepare meals in batches and freeze individual portions for later. This uses up ingredients before they spoil and provides convenient homemade meals.		sustainability:meal-prep;batch-cooking	0
If you have extra food after cooking, share it with friends or neighbors. This fosters community connections and reduces waste.		sustainability:sharing;leftovers	0
Besides donating food, consider volunteering or donating funds to food banks. Operational support helps them rescue more food and serve more people.		sustainability:volunteer;support	0
Nose-to-tail cooking means using all edible parts of an animal, including organs and bones. This reduces waste and provides a variety of nutrients.		sustainability:nose-to-tail;cooking	0
Variety in your diet supports biodiversity and resilient food systems. It reduces reliance on a few resource-intensive crops and helps maintain soil fertility.		sustainability:diversity;diet	0
Don't throw away carrot tops, onion skins or chicken bones. Use these scraps to make nutrient-rich broths and stocks. It's a zero-waste technique that extracts flavor from parts you might otherwise discard.		sustainability:scraps;cooking	0
When you grow herbs like basil, mint or parsley at home, you can harvest small amounts as needed. This eliminates waste from store-bought bundles that often spoil before being used.		sustainability:home-garden;herbs	0
Involve children in planning meals, shopping and cooking. Teach them the value of food and the environmental impact of waste. Developing these habits early can lead to lifelong sustainability.		sustainability:education;children	0